

The One-Box Guide

Every job one cheap box of baking soda does around the house — room by room.

You watched the 60 seconds. Here is the whole thing. One dollar box of baking soda quietly does the work of a shelf full of branded sprays and powders. It scrubs, deodorizes, and softens — no harsh fumes, no twenty-dollar bottles. Here is the whole house.

KITCHEN

- **Scour pots and the sink** — a paste of baking soda and a little water lifts baked-on food and stains without scratching.
- **Kill fridge odors** — an open box on a shelf absorbs smells; swap it every couple of months.
- **Freshen a slow drain** — pour some down, follow with hot water (a splash of vinegar for a harmless fizz) to cut grease and odor.
- **Rescue a scorched pan** — simmer water with a few spoonfuls to loosen burnt-on food, then wipe clean.

BATHROOM

- **Scrub tub, tile, and grout** — the mild abrasive cleans without scratching the enamel.
- **Deodorize** — a light sprinkle in the trash bin, or on a damp sponge for wiping surfaces.
- **Freshen the toilet** — sprinkle in, let it sit a few minutes, then brush.

- **Boost the wash** — a half-cup in the laundry helps lift odors and softens the water so detergent works better.
 - **Refresh carpets and mattresses** — sprinkle, leave fifteen minutes, then vacuum it up.
 - **Freshen shoes** — a spoonful in each one overnight, tapped out in the morning.
 - **Wipe away scuffs** — a soft paste lifts marks off walls and grime off most surfaces.
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KEEP THIS IN MIND

One caution: skip baking soda on aluminum cookware, antique or coated surfaces, and anything the maker labels "no abrasives." On everything else here, it is the cheapest cleaner you will ever buy.

A whole shelf of bottles, replaced by one honest box. That is not going without — it is a man who simply stopped paying for packaging. — The Sage

SOURCES Arm & Hammer (armandhammer.com) · University cooperative extension, household cleaning guides · FDA / USDA (baking soda as a food-safe cleaner)